

PRESS YOUR STRIPES.

**A zebra ironing its coat.
A complete, illustrated construction guide.**



30 core steps · 4 optional extension steps · supplied starter images

Why / Check / Fix at every stage. Includes an editable-file workflow, troubleshooting, reflection and teacher preflight notes.

Reference: a teaching composite assembled from the supplied photographs, not a Photoshop screenshot.

One illusion. A visible process.

Build an impossible scene from real supplied photographs. Isolate a rearing zebra, pose its hoof, drape its stripes over an ironing board, and make the pieces share light, depth and a communication purpose.

Core / build the action

Complete Steps 01–30. Keep the animal striped and make a matching costume panel hang over the board. This is the complete, assessable project, not an unfinished version.

Supported / keep moving

With teacher approval, use `left_zebra_cutout.png` at Step 07, `board_without_loose_cord.png` at Step 08, or `stripe_patch.jpg` at Step 16. Still do the pose, warp, masking, shadows and explanation yourself. Name the support used.

Challenge / the coat comes off

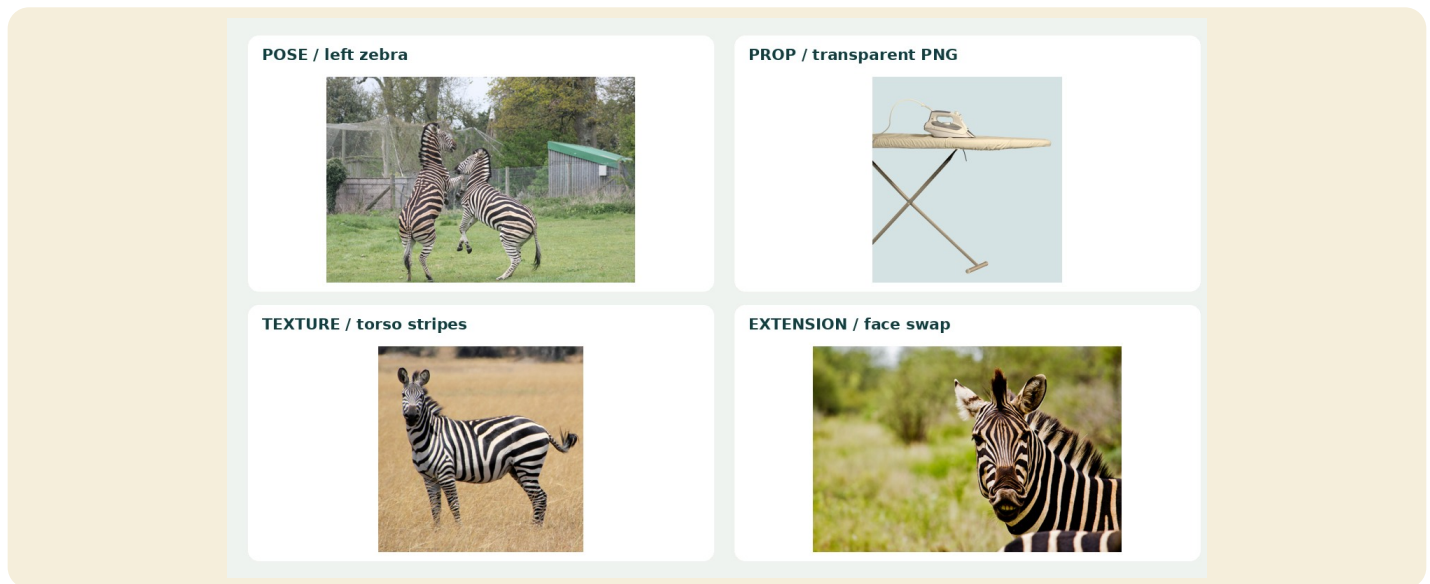
Save a separate copy. X1–X2 create a smooth cream costume under the striped coat. X3–X4 replace the expression. These extensions are optional and need more time.

Teacher planning estimate: 4–5 classes of 70 minutes for the full raw-asset route; 2–3 with prepared cut-outs. Extensions need additional time.

Find your place

Plan & prepare	Steps 01–03 · page 6
Isolate & arrange	Steps 04–10 · page 9
Make the action	Steps 11–14 · page 16
Build the coat	Steps 15–20 · page 20
Integrate & finish	Steps 21–27 · page 26
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Optional extensions	Overview page 36 · X1–X4 from page 37
Troubleshooting / evidence	Pages 41–43
Teacher notes / sources	Pages 44–46

Use the supplied photographs



Source roles are specific: the pose, board, texture and optional head are not interchangeable.

img_8872.jpg	2048 × 1365 LEFT rearing zebra: body and working foreleg. Begin at Step 04.
ironing_board.png	1494 × 1621 Transparent board + iron. The cable is distracting; the left frame is cropped. Begin at Step 08.
zebra.jpg	2038 × 2048 Clean torso stripe texture; crop x 760–1260 and y 810–1260. Begin at Step 15.
Zebra_in_South_Africa.jpg	2048 × 1365 Optional alternate head/expression. Not the core body source. Extension X3.
Untitled-2.psd	2020 × 1032 Supplied rough layered draft. Construction reference only; preserve unchanged. Extension X4 reference.

Prepared cut-outs and the exact stripe crop are in **support**. Use with teacher approval and identify them in your process record. Keep the supplied PSD unchanged; begin your own new document.

Image rights and creator attributions were not established here. Confirm permission before public source redistribution. Full provenance notes: page 46.

Select the right target first

Image thumbnail

Click it to transform the object or start a selection. A small Smart Object badge identifies embedded content.

Layer mask

Click its black-and-white thumbnail before masking. White reveals; black hides; grey gives partial visibility. Painting on the photo changes pixels instead.

Clipping mask

A separate layer uses the transparency of the base below it. Use it to keep painted folds or a colour adjustment on the coat. It does not replace the coat's silhouette mask. [S7]

Nested Smart Object

Converting a masked object again encloses the cut-out and mask. Double-click the outer thumbnail to reopen the contents; save that embedded tab after editing. [S3]

Puppet Warp vs Transform Warp

Puppet Warp uses anchor pins for the foreleg. Transform Warp uses a mesh for the coat. This task does not use Perspective Warp. [S4–S5]

Starting values, not rules

Brush size, opacity and coordinates assume 1600 × 1200 px. Make small adjustments to fit your own selection and composition. A visual check matters more than matching a number.

Windows / Mac keyboard pairs

Move / Brush / Lasso	V / B / L
Free Transform	Ctrl/Cmd+T
Duplicate layer	Ctrl/Cmd+J
Deselect	Ctrl/Cmd+D
Group selected layers	Ctrl/Cmd+G
Fit / 100% view	Ctrl/Cmd+0 / Ctrl/Cmd+1
Undo / Save	Ctrl/Cmd+Z / Ctrl/Cmd+S

Ctrl/Cmd means Ctrl on Windows or Command on Mac. Alt/Option means Alt on Windows or Option on Mac. Shortcuts assume the standard mapping.

Build to relationships, not guesses



Final-scene blueprint for orientation. These guides refer to visible objects, not the hidden full rectangle of a source photo.

Canvas	1600 × 1200 px; RGB, 8 bit; 72 ppi
Visible animal	Approximately x 270–650, y 220–1120
Tabletop	Approximately x 420–1045, y 625–670
Hoof/handle contact	Near x 660, y 570
Coat top plane	Top y 622–631; fold y 651–660
Hanging hem	Corners y 843–852; centre near y 880
Floor / ground contact	Floor starts y 960; contact near y 1120
Type zone	Right of x 950; leave breathing room

The font, automatic selection and exact mask can vary. Keep the contact points convincing rather than forcing every point to match a number.

Read the illusion before editing

Select first: No Photoshop layer yet
Tools / menu: Visual planning



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Compare the finished reference with **img_8872.jpg**, **ironing_board.png** and **zebra.jpg**. The rearing animal supplies the pose; a separate torso crop becomes the fabric.
- 2 Sketch three large shapes: the upright zebra on the left, a waist-height board, and a hanging striped coat. Leave the right side open for a headline.
- 3 Mark the three contact points: hoof on handle, iron on fabric, and feet on the floor. Draw a small arrow for light coming from the upper left/front.
- 4 Use the **striped-animal version** for the core task. The optional extension creates the joke that its coat has been taken off.

WHY The humour is the impossible action. The believable details are ordinary: overlapping surfaces, cloth hanging down, and objects touching the ground.

CHECK A viewer should understand “zebra doing its ironing” without needing to read the headline.

FIX Do not begin by trying to rotate a four-legged zebra upright. The rearing pose already solves most of that problem.

Visual: teaching composite / annotation, not an application screenshot.

Create and save the working document

Select first: New document

Tools / menu: File > New; Save As



Layout blueprint shown with the completed scene for orientation; your new file will still be blank.

DO THIS

- 1 Extract the classroom ZIP. Keep **starters**, **assets** and **support** together. When using only the standalone HTML, download the starter images below into a folder named **starters**. Make **YourName_Zebra** for your own work.
- 2 Choose **File > New**: Width **1600 pixels**, Height **1200 pixels**, RGB Color, **8 bit**, Resolution **72 pixels/inch**, and a white background. Use sRGB when a profile is offered; leave Artboards off.
- 3 Choose **File > Save As** and save **YourName_Zebra_Ironing_v01.psd** on the computer. Keep Photoshop layers enabled.
- 4 Open **Window > Layers**, **Window > Properties** and **Window > Info**. Press **Ctrl/Cmd+R**; right-click a ruler and choose Pixels.

WHY Pixel dimensions control this screen-sized project. The 72 ppi setting also makes the suggested type sizes easier to follow; it does not add or remove detail by itself.

CHECK The document is landscape, 1600 by 1200 pixels, and your first PSD exists in your own folder.

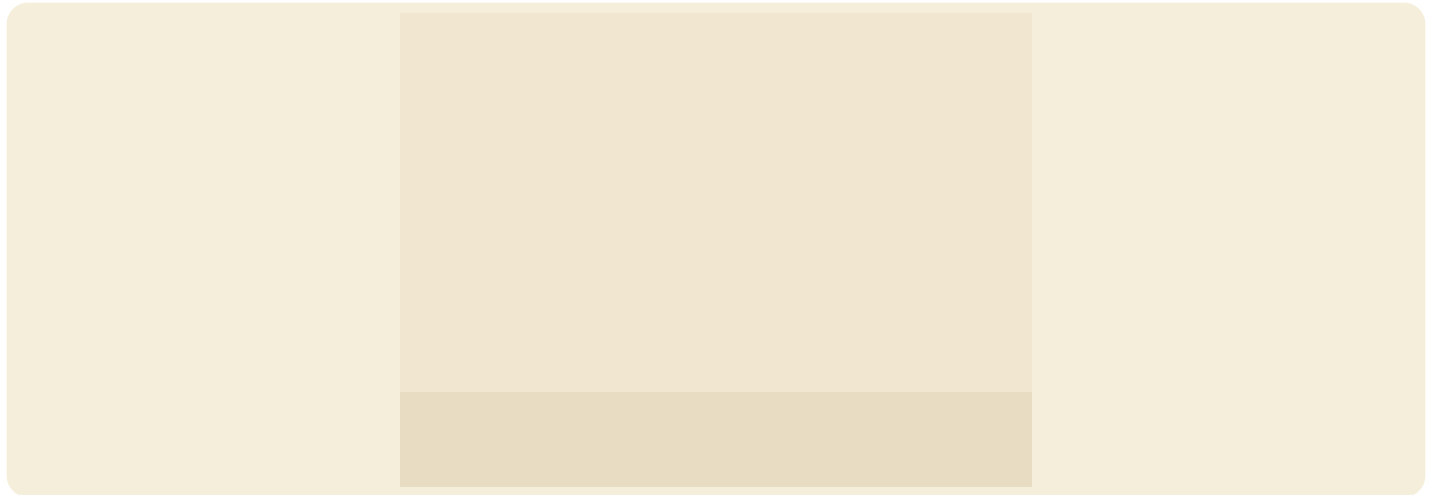
FIX Do not enter 1600 centimetres or inches. Check the units before clicking Create. Save a local PSD, not only an exported JPG.

Visual: teaching composite / annotation, not an application screenshot.

Build a simple studio and layout guides

Select first: Background; then Floor

Tools / menu: Solid Color fill; Rectangle tool



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Choose **Layer > New Fill Layer > Solid Color**. Name it **Background** and enter **#F1E7D0** in the colour picker.
- 2 Select the **Rectangle tool (U)**. Set the tool mode to **Shape**, Fill to **#E8DCC3** and Stroke to None. Draw a rectangle over the bottom 240 pixels: approximately x 0, y 960, width 1600, height 240. Name it **Floor**.
- 3 Drag a vertical guide from the left ruler to x **950**. Drag a horizontal guide from the top ruler to y **1120**. Use the Info panel or the moving ruler label to read the position.
- 4 Shift-select Background and Floor and press **Ctrl/Cmd+G**. Name the group **01 Studio**. Keep later object layers above it.

WHY A plain studio removes the need to rebuild a zoo background. It also leaves the cut-outs, fabric and shadows easy to judge.

CHECK There is a warm background, a slightly darker floor band, a type zone on the right and a ground-contact guide near the bottom.

FIX A shape outline with no visible fill means Fill is set to None. If the whole canvas changes, check whether the wrong layer was selected.

Visual: teaching composite / annotation, not an application screenshot.

Place the rearing-zebra source

Select first: Zebra Source – image thumbnail

Tools / menu: File > Place Embedded



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Choose **File > Place Embedded** and select **starters/img_8872.jpg**. Press Enter/Return to accept the initial placement.
- 2 Rename the placed layer **Zebra Source**. Do not worry about its final size yet.
- 3 Click its **image thumbnail**, not an adjustment or mask. Select the **Object Selection tool** from the W-tool group; click and hold the toolbar icon to see the other tools.
- 4 Turn **Sample All Layers off** while selecting this source. Work on the photo itself, not the whole assembled scene.

WHY Placing the file as an embedded Smart Object keeps the source packaged inside the document and supports later resizing without repeatedly resampling the original.

CHECK The Layers panel shows the source photo and a small Smart Object badge. Both zebras are still visible.

FIX Changing a mask rather than the image is a common wrong-target error. Select the image thumbnail before making the object selection.

Tool references: S1, S3. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Select the left zebra only

Select first: Zebra Source – image thumbnail

Tools / menu: Object Selection; Lasso



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 With Object Selection, draw a rectangle around the **left, upright zebra**. Keep its ears, tail, hind feet and raised foreleg inside the rectangle.
- 2 If both animals are included, switch the tool to **Subtract from selection** and draw around the right-hand zebra. Use the tool's plus/minus controls rather than guessing a shortcut.
- 3 Use **Lasso (L)** in Add to selection mode to restore missed ears or hooves. Use Subtract mode to remove fence and grass between the limbs.
- 4 Zoom to at least 100% with **Ctrl/Cmd+plus**. Inspect where the two animals overlap; correct that boundary manually before moving on.

WHY Automatic selection provides a starting boundary. The overlapping legs are a design judgement the student must check.

CHECK Only the left animal is selected. The neighbouring zebra and the empty spaces between legs are outside the selection.

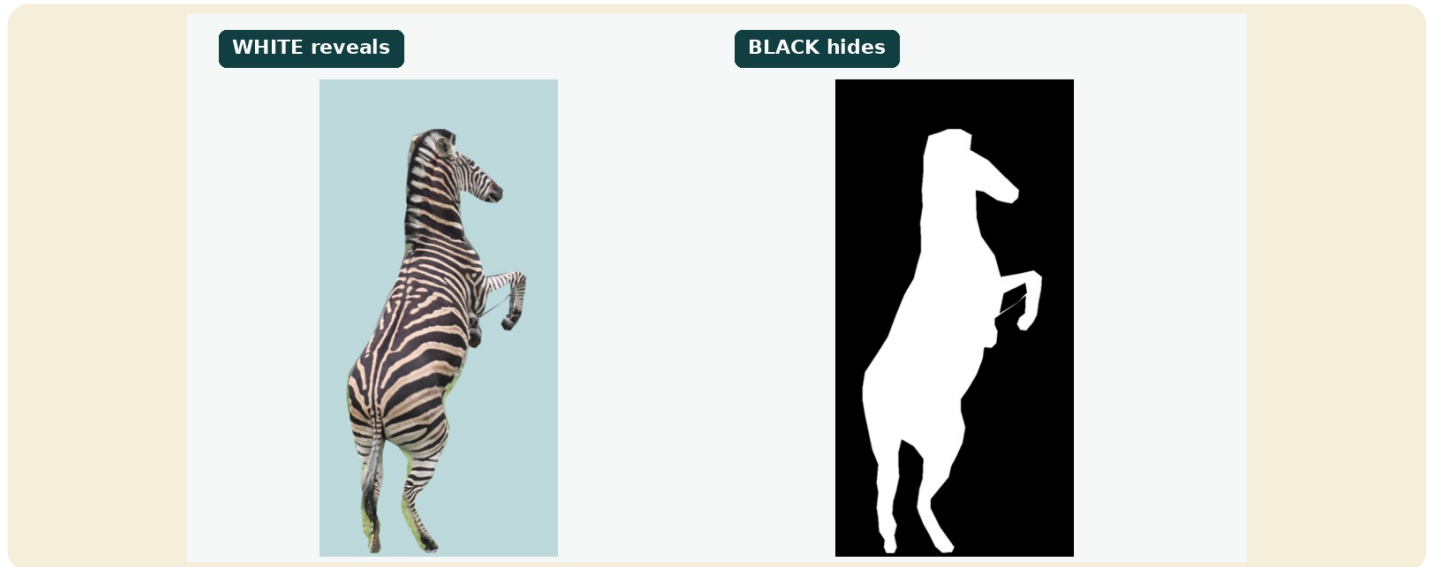
FIX A global Select Subject command may select both animals. Return to a local rectangle/lasso and subtract unwanted regions.

Tool references: S1. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Refine fur, then output a mask

Select first: Zebra Source – active selection

Tools / menu: Select > Select and Mask



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Choose **Select > Select and Mask**. Check the edge using both **On Black** and **On White** preview modes.
- 2 Start gently: Smooth **1**, Feather **0.5 px**, Contrast **10%**, Shift Edge **-3%**. Treat these as starting values, not a preset that must suit every edge.
- 3 With the **Refine Edge Brush**, make short strokes across the mane and tail edges only. Do not brush across the interior stripes or the entire body.
- 4 Under Output Settings, choose **Layer Mask** and click OK. Leave Decontaminate Colors off for this first pass. Paint black on the resulting mask to hide remaining fence; paint white to restore lost fur.

WHY A mask hides pixels instead of permanently erasing them. Black-and-white preview backgrounds expose different edge problems.

CHECK The zoo background is hidden. The mask thumbnail is white over the animal and black over the surroundings; the original pixels remain recoverable.

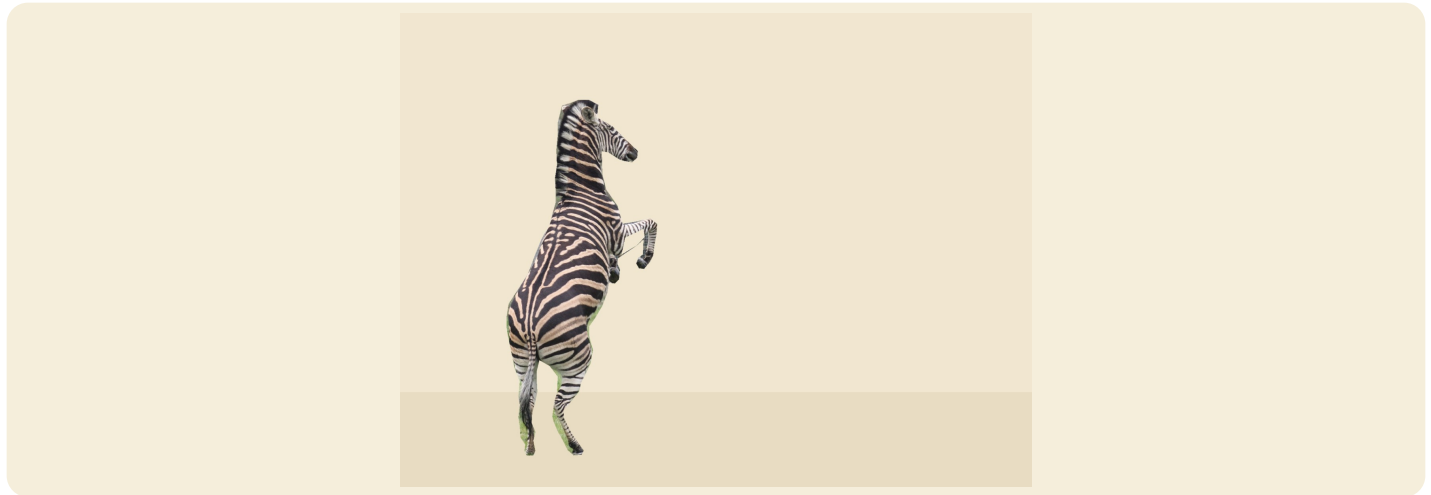
FIX A large Feather value creates a blurred halo. Undo and reduce it. If brushing changes the animal's colour, select the mask thumbnail first.

Tool references: S2. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Scale the animal and protect the cut-out

Select first: Zebra Source and its linked mask

Tools / menu: Free Transform; Convert to Smart Object



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Click the source image thumbnail and choose **Edit > Free Transform** or press **Ctrl/Cmd+T**. Keep the width/height link enabled for proportional scaling.
- 2 Scale and move the visible animal to roughly **x 270-650, y 220-1120**. The feet should sit near the ground guide; leave the right side open.
- 3 Press Enter/Return. Rename the layer **Zebra Body**. Keep its image and mask linked so they move together.
- 4 Choose **Layer > Smart Objects > Convert to Smart Object** once more. This nests the refined mask with the image. Double-clicking the new thumbnail later opens the embedded source and its original mask.

WHY The second Smart Object encloses the cut-out, so later posing acts on the isolated animal rather than on a hidden rectangular photo.

CHECK The complete animal is upright, both hind feet fit on the page, and no new background appears after resizing.

FIX Do not rely on an old instruction to always hold Shift while scaling. Inspect the width/height link; Photoshop's transform behaviour depends on its settings.

Tool references: S3. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Place the board behind the animal

Select first: Board Base – image thumbnail

Tools / menu: Place Embedded; Free Transform



Placement target shown after cable cleanup and frame repair (Steps 09–10).

DO THIS

- 1 Use **File > Place Embedded** to place **ironing_board.png**. Name it **Board Base** and drag it **below Zebra Body**, but above 01 Studio.
- 2 Scale proportionally. Target a visible tabletop from approximately **x 420 to 1045**, near **y 625–670**. The right frame foot should reach about y 1115.
- 3 The iron is already part of this PNG. Its handle should be near **x 650–700, y 570–595**. Use this as the target for the hoof in a later step.
- 4 Accept the transform. Keep the board level. Do not stretch the entire board vertically just to make the handle meet the hoof.

WHY The board's placement establishes the action. We adjust a small independent foreleg later instead of distorting the entire animal or iron.

CHECK The board is behind the torso, the iron is near the raised leg, and the frame is close to the floor.

FIX A PNG is not automatically background-free, but this supplied one contains transparency. Do not use **Select > Color Range** to delete all white; that could remove the iron itself.

Tool references: S3. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Hide the loose cable without erasing the iron

Select first: Board Base – layer mask
Tools / menu: Add Layer Mask; Brush



Target after prop cleanup; the frame repair is completed in Step 10.

DO THIS

- 1 Select Board Base and click the **Add Layer Mask** button at the bottom of Layers.
- 2 Click the new white mask thumbnail. Press **B**, set a soft round brush to about **20-35 px**, Opacity 100%, and set the foreground colour to black.
- 3 Paint over the loose cable arcing above the left end of the board. Stop before the iron housing and tabletop. Work at 200% near those edges.
- 4 Use a smaller brush near the cable plug; press **X** to switch black/white when you need to restore a mistake. Leave the original iron visible on this lower layer.

WHY This is a selective cleanup, not a second background removal. Keeping the original iron will make an aligned duplicate easier to manage.

CHECK The distracting cable is hidden, while the cream iron, handle opening and board cover remain intact.

FIX Do not paint on the image thumbnail. Do not remove a large rectangle above the board: it may also cut off the iron.

Visual: teaching composite / annotation, not an application screenshot.

Repair the cropped lower frame

Select first: Frame Repair – blank pixel layer

Tools / menu: Brush; sampled colour; mask



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 The supplied board is cropped on the left. Inspect the lower-left diagonal support: it can appear to stop before the floor.
- 2 Create a blank pixel layer named **Frame Repair** below Board Base. Select Brush, Hardness about **85%**, Opacity 100%, diameter about **12 px**. Hold Alt/Option briefly to sample the metal's midtone.
- 3 Click at the existing lower-left support end, then Shift-click at the floor behind the zebra's left hind foot. In the reference this runs roughly from **(425,1015)** to **(333,1120)**.
- 4 With a 3 px brush, sample a lighter edge and add one parallel highlight; add a narrow darker edge on the opposite side. Mask any excess and keep the repaired support behind the animal.

WHY A cropped prop needs a deliberate solution. This short, shaded extension is more convincing than a frame that floats halfway down.

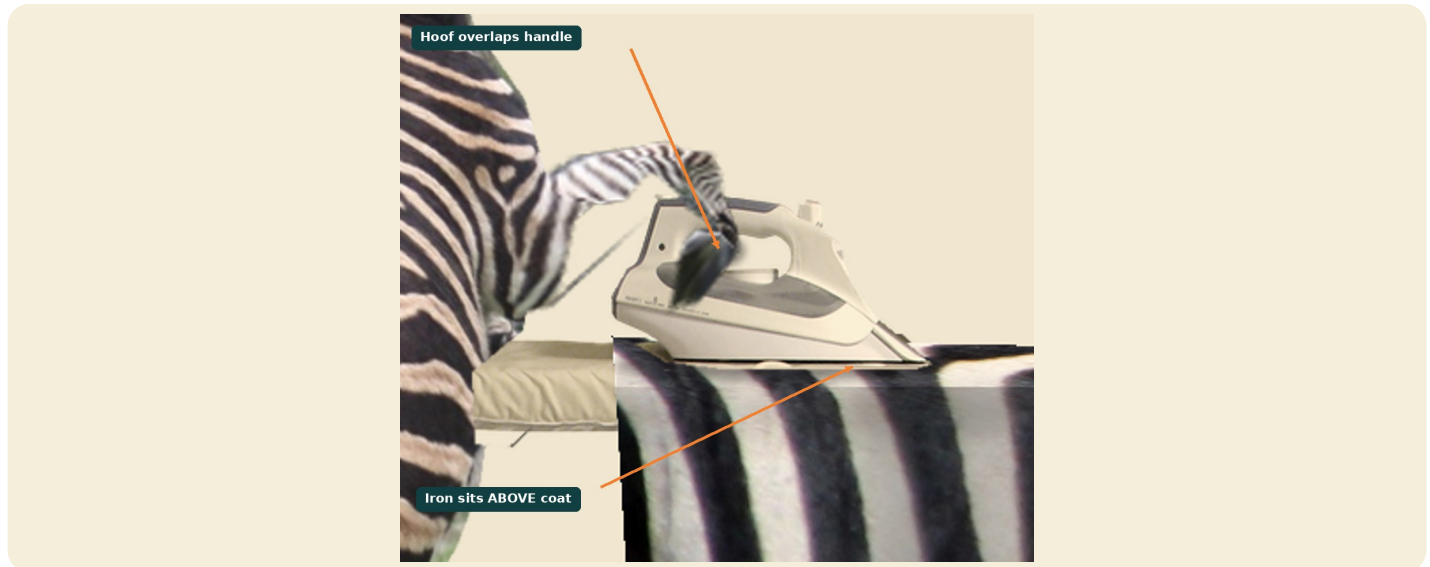
CHECK The support continues along its original diagonal and meets the same floor as the other foot. It is largely hidden behind the zebra.

FIX Do not invent a differently angled support. Extend the direction already visible. A uniformly thick black stroke will look drawn rather than metallic.

Visual: teaching composite / annotation, not an application screenshot.

Lift the iron into a separate top layer

Select first: Iron Top – duplicate of Board Base
Tools / menu: Duplicate; replace duplicate mask



Final close-up explains the iron/coat/hoof relationship. Fabric and contact shadows come later.

DO THIS

- 1 Select Board Base and press **Ctrl/Cmd+J**. Rename the copy **Iron Top** and move it above Zebra Body. **Do not move or resize it.**
- 2 On the copy only, right-click its mask and choose **Delete Layer Mask**, not Apply. This removes the cleanup mask from the copy, not from Board Base.
- 3 Click the copy's image thumbnail. Use Lasso to trace the complete iron housing and soleplate. Exclude the cable and board, but do not cut into the handle.
- 4 Click **Add Layer Mask** to reveal only the selected iron. The existing transparent handle opening stays transparent. Later, put the coat between Board Base and Iron Top.

WHY This creates a sandwich: board underneath, coat in the middle, iron on top. The lower original iron is concealed by its perfectly aligned duplicate.

CHECK Turning Iron Top off and on does not make the iron jump. There is still only one visible iron.

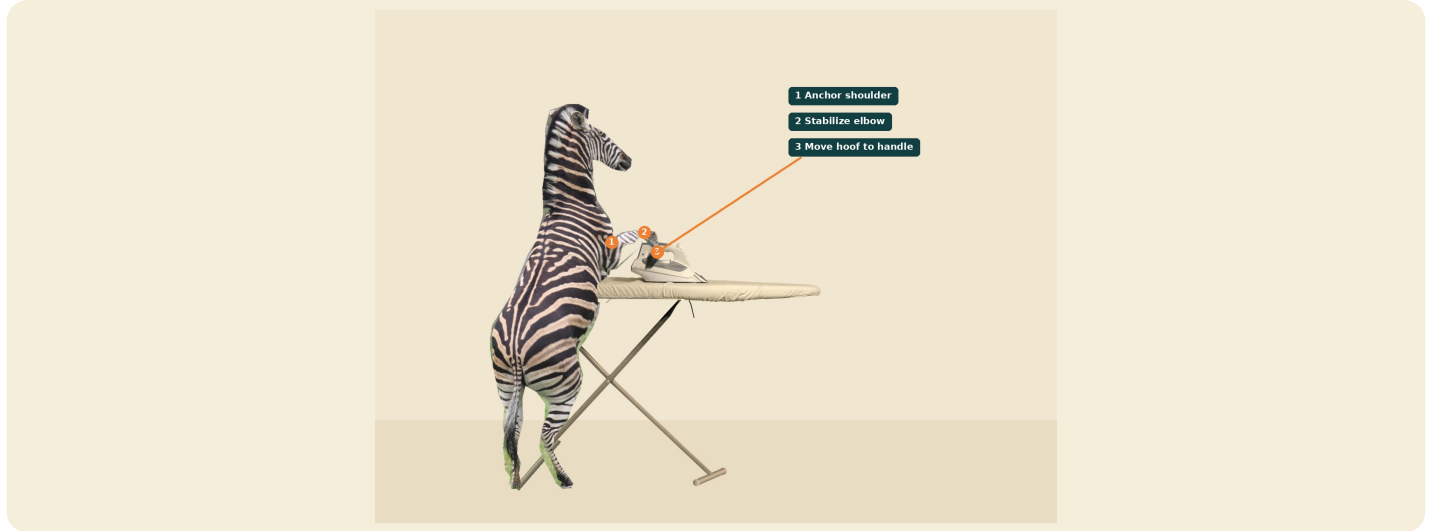
FIX A doubled edge means the duplicate moved. Undo or realign it precisely. Do not move Iron Top independently unless you also remove the lower original.

Visual: teaching composite / annotation, not an application screenshot.

Separate the working foreleg

Select first: Foreleg – duplicate; then Zebra Body mask

Tools / menu: Duplicate; Lasso; layer masks



Target foreleg pose and pin locations. You will apply the actual pose in Step 13.

DO THIS

- 1 Duplicate **Zebra Body**, name the copy **Foreleg**, and move it above Iron Top. Keep it aligned with the body for now.
- 2 On the Foreleg image thumbnail, use Lasso to select the **forward bent foreleg**, including a short overlap into the shoulder. Click Add Layer Mask. Only this limb should remain visible on the duplicate.
- 3 Convert Foreleg to a Smart Object so its limb mask is nested inside. This keeps the upcoming Puppet Warp mesh limited to the cut-out.
- 4 On Zebra Body, add a new outer mask. With black, hide the old working foreleg and the spare hanging forehoof. Do not remove the shoulder; leave a 10–20 px overlap under the separate limb.

WHY A separate limb can move without dragging the face, stripes or entire body. The shoulder overlap is material for blending, not a mistake.

CHECK Hide Foreleg temporarily: the base should have no duplicate bent foreleg. Show it again: there is one working limb, joined at the shoulder.

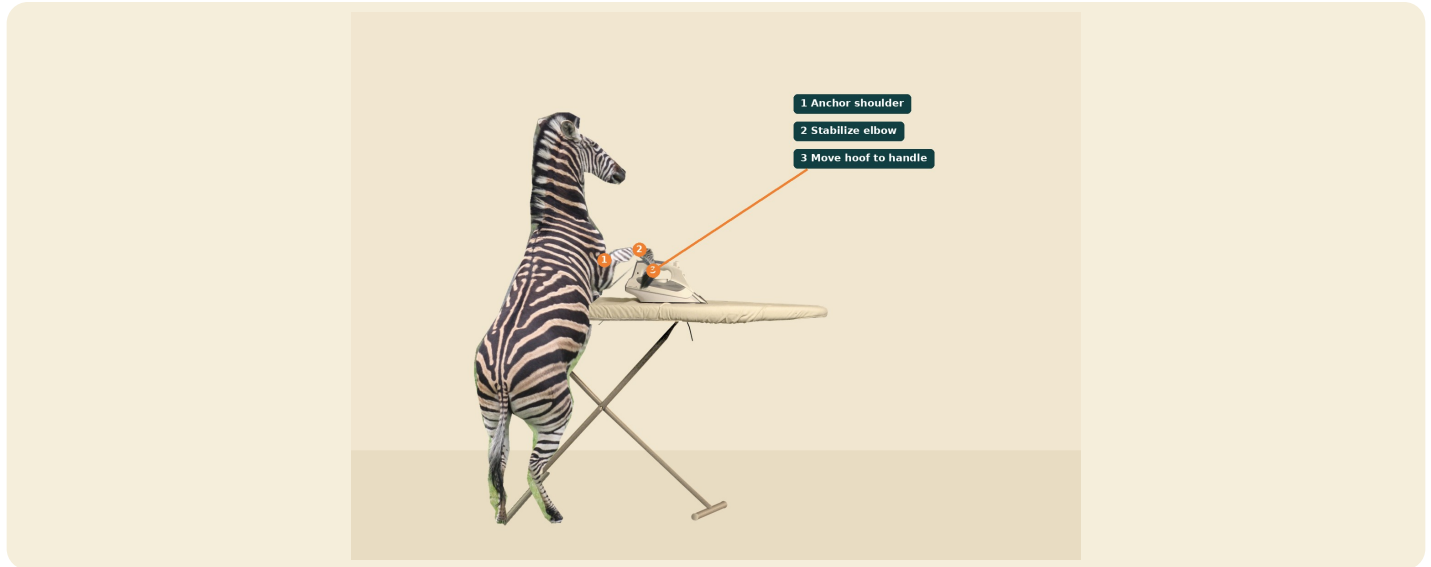
FIX If the old limb reappears after posing, you missed part of it on the body mask. If a gap opens at the shoulder, restore a little overlap with white.

Tool references: S3. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Pose the hoof with three anchor pins

Select first: Foreleg – Smart Object thumbnail

Tools / menu: Edit > Puppet Warp



Annotated posing target, not a capture of Photoshop's Puppet Warp mesh.

DO THIS

- 1 Select the **Foreleg image thumbnail** and choose **Edit > Puppet Warp**. Start with Mode Normal, Density Normal and Expansion about 2 px.
- 2 Add a pin near the shoulder, one at the elbow and one inside the hoof. The shoulder pin is the anchor; it should not move.
- 3 Drag the hoof pin toward the top of the iron handle, roughly **(660,570)** in this layout. Adjust the elbow pin a little to keep a natural bend. Avoid stretching the limb longer than necessary.
- 4 Turn Show Mesh off briefly to judge the pose. Press Enter/Return to apply. Add a fourth stabilizing pin only when an area bends unintentionally.

WHY Pins allow local posing. A small believable change is stronger than a rubbery limb forced across a large gap.

CHECK The hoof meets the handle, the shoulder still joins the torso, and the leg's stripe widths remain reasonably consistent.

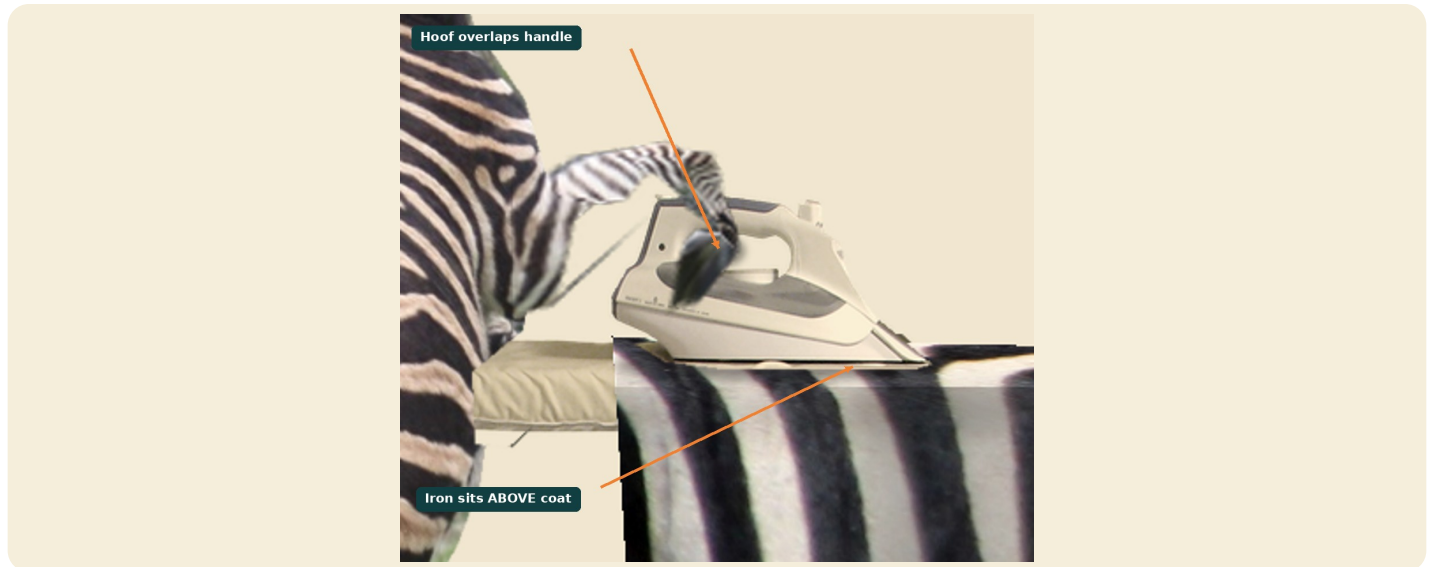
FIX A huge rectangular mesh means you are warping the full source photo. Cancel and enclose the masked limb in a Smart Object first. If the pose needs extreme distortion, move the board closer.

Tool references: S4. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Refine the grip and shoulder join

Select first: Foreleg – new outer mask

Tools / menu: Brush on mask; zoom



Close-up of the finished overlap. Additional fabric and shadow work is introduced next.

DO THIS

- 1 Add an outer mask to Foreleg. Zoom to **200%** at the shoulder and iron handle.
- 2 With a 10–20 px soft brush, paint black on the mask to blend the shoulder overlap. Keep enough limb visible to preserve its volume.
- 3 At the handle, use a 3–8 px brush at higher hardness. Keep the near edge of the hoof in front of the handle. Hide stray pixels that spill into the iron body.
- 4 Compare at Fit on Screen, then return to 100%. This is a playful hoof resting on a handle, not a human hand with fingers. Do not carve artificial fingers into it.

WHY The small overlap is the visual proof that the zebra is operating the iron. A clean shoulder join prevents the limb looking pasted on.

CHECK The limb reads as one connected foreleg and its hoof touches rather than floats above the handle.

FIX A perfectly soft edge against the hard iron looks blurred. Use a firmer mask edge there and a softer transition only at the furry shoulder.

Visual: teaching composite / annotation, not an application screenshot.

Extract a clean stripe patch

Select first: zebra.jpg – separate source document

Tools / menu: Rectangular Marquee; Layer via Copy



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Choose **File > Open** and open **starters/zebra.jpg** in a separate tab. This is the nearly square, full-body zebra, not the close-up portrait.
- 2 Select **Rectangular Marquee (M)**. Set Style to **Fixed Size**, Width **500 px**, Height **450 px**. Watch Window > Info as you move the cursor; click near **x 760, y 810** to place the selection's upper-left. Drag inside it to correct its position.
- 3 Confirm the selection ends near x 1260, y 1260 and contains only striped torso: no grass, mane, head, belly outline or legs. Press **Ctrl/Cmd+J** to copy those pixels to a new layer.
- 4 Name the new layer **Coat Texture**. Set the Marquee tool's Style back to Normal when finished. The support folder contains this exact crop as **stripe_patch.jpg** for recovery.

WHY A rectangular piece of texture is easier to turn into fabric than a cut-out animal torso with recognisable legs and anatomy.

CHECK The patch is filled edge-to-edge with black and cream stripes. There are no background holes or recognisable body parts.

FIX A pale triangle at an edge is probably background or the belly contour. Move the selection inward rather than cloning a large repair.

Visual: teaching composite / annotation, not an application screenshot.

Place the coat between board and iron

Select first: Coat Texture – image thumbnail

Tools / menu: Duplicate Layer to document; Free Transform



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 In the source tab, right-click Coat Texture and choose **Duplicate Layer**. Set Document to your main zebra PSD. Return to the main tab.
- 2 Drag Coat Texture **above Zebra Body but below Iron Top**. Convert it to a Smart Object.
- 3 Use Ctrl/Cmd+T to place it roughly over the right half of the board. Begin near **x 600, y 622**, about **400 px wide**; it should extend below the tabletop.
- 4 Leave the full rectangular texture intact for the next step. Do not mask it to the flat board top: the front must hang down in front of the frame.

WHY The coat needs two visible planes: a narrow surface under the iron and a broad hanging front. Layer order supplies the occlusion before shading does.

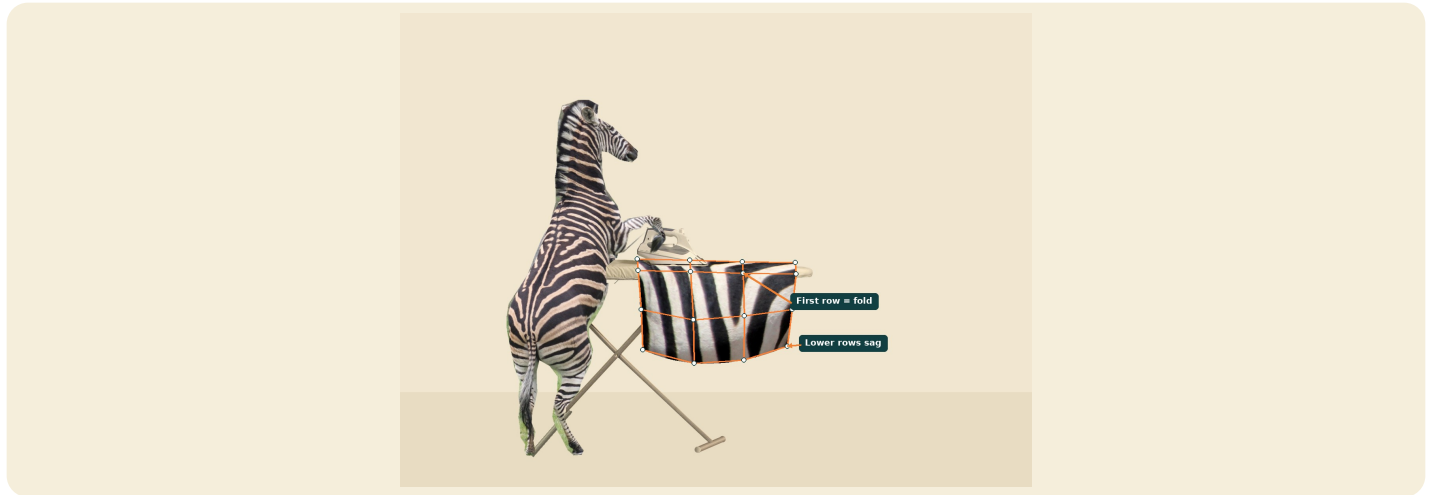
CHECK The iron and hoof appear in front of the stripe patch. The patch hides part of the board and its supports.

FIX If the stripe patch covers the iron, reorder it below Iron Top. If the board covers the patch, move the patch above Board Base.

Tool references: S3. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Warp one continuous texture over the edge

Select first: Coat Texture – Smart Object thumbnail
Tools / menu: Edit > Transform > Warp; 3x3 grid



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Choose **Edit > Transform > Warp**. In the Options bar set Grid to **3x3**. The first interior horizontal row will become the board's front fold.
- 2 Move the four top-row points close to a line from **(600,622)** to **(1000,631)**. Move the first interior row to a line from roughly **(602,651)** to **(1002,660)**. This compresses the upper third into the top surface.
- 3 Pull the bottom row down: outer corners near **(614,852)** and **(980,843)**; middle points around **y 880**. Let the centre sag lower than the sides.
- 4 Use the remaining interior row to make two gentle vertical folds. Adjust curve handles slightly so the hem is smooth, not angular. Accept the warp.

WHY One texture crossing the fold keeps stripe continuity. The compressed upper region reads as a surface receding away from the viewer.

CHECK The fabric bends over the board edge and hangs in front. Stripes flow continuously between the top and front, rather than restarting at a seam.

FIX Do not use Perspective Warp for this task. That is a different command. If the mesh folds over itself, undo that movement and keep the top rows in order.

Tool references: S5, S6. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Shape the hem and fit the fabric

Select first: Coat Texture – outer layer mask

Tools / menu: Layer mask; Brush



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Add a layer mask to Coat Texture after the warp. Zoom in on the top corners and hanging side edges.
- 2 Use a 10–20 px brush, Hardness about 70%, with black on the mask to remove sharp corner spikes and any texture extending behind the back edge of the board.
- 3 Round the bottom corners gently. Keep a continuous curved hem; do not erase large random scallops. Preserve the top strip directly underneath the iron.
- 4 Check at Fit on Screen. The coat can hang like a loose blanket or costume panel; it does not need recognisable sleeves to communicate the visual joke.

WHY The silhouette sells the material before fine texture does. A clean, weighted hem is more convincing than the original rectangular crop.

CHECK The iron has fabric under its entire soleplate, and the hanging front covers part of the stand naturally.

FIX If the entire front disappears, the mask was inverted or painted too broadly. Paint white to restore it, then trim only the outer edge.

Visual: teaching composite / annotation, not an application screenshot.

Paint shadow folds on a clipped layer

Select first: Coat Shadows – clipped to Coat Texture

Tools / menu: New layer; Multiply; clipping mask



Illustrated fold-lighting target, including the restrained highlights added in Step 20.

DO THIS

- 1 Create a blank layer immediately above Coat Texture. Name it **Coat Shadows**. Choose **Layer > Create Clipping Mask**, then change its blend mode to **Multiply**.
- 2 Choose a soft round brush, Hardness 0%, size about 50–80 px, Opacity **10–15%**. Sample a dark warm grey rather than a bright colour.
- 3 Paint narrow, vertical shadow bands down the hanging front, following the curves already made in Warp. Add a slightly darker band just below the board's fold.
- 4 Build the effect with a few strokes. Toggle the layer on and off; reduce its layer opacity if the cream stripes become muddy. Keep the tabletop lighter than the front.

WHY Warp changes the outline and stripe direction, but it does not automatically create convincing light. Clipped shadow painting supplies the fabric's depth.

CHECK The shadows stay inside the coat. The folds affect black and cream areas together, not just one stripe colour.

FIX Shadow paint outside the cloth means the layer is not clipped to the correct base. Look for the clipping arrow and keep the clipped layers consecutive.

Tool references: S7, S9. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Add restrained highlights

Select first: Coat Highlights – clipped in the same stack

Tools / menu: Screen; soft brush



Fold-lighting checkpoint before the separate contact and ground shadows.

DO THIS

- 1 Create **Coat Highlights** immediately above Coat Shadows. Clip it to the same Coat Texture base. Set the blend mode to **Screen**.
- 2 Choose a pale warm colour such as **#E8DCC3**. Use a soft brush at **5-8% opacity**, diameter roughly 30–45 px.
- 3 Paint beside, not on top of, each dark fold. Add a thin, soft lift along the top fold where the fabric turns over the board edge.
- 4 Lower the whole layer's opacity until the effect is subtle. You should still recognise the original black stripes; do not turn them grey everywhere.

WHY A highlight beside a shadow suggests a curved surface. The paired changes make a flat texture read as folded material.

CHECK The coat has a light-facing ridge and a darker recess, without looking glossy or metallic.

FIX Very bright white strokes look painted on. Use lower opacity and a larger soft brush, or undo and build the change gradually.

Tool references: S7, S9. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Add a tight shadow beneath the iron

Select first: Iron Contact – below Iron Top, above coat stack

Tools / menu: Multiply; soft brush



Iron contact added; the animal and stand will be grounded later.

DO THIS

- 1 Create a blank layer named **Iron Contact** directly below Iron Top and above the coat layers. Set it to Multiply.
- 2 Use a dark warm grey soft brush, about **6-12 px**, Opacity **20%**. Paint a narrow shadow following the underside of the soleplate.
- 3 The shadow should touch the iron with no gap. Keep it short and darkest immediately beneath the iron; avoid a large oval floating around it.
- 4 Adjust layer opacity, usually in the **35-65%** range, until the iron looks seated on the fabric. Judge it at 100% and at page size.

WHY Contact shadows are tight where surfaces touch. This prevents the iron from looking like a separate sticker.

CHECK The soleplate appears to press onto the striped fabric, not hover above it.

FIX An oversized blurred shadow makes the iron look lifted away from the coat. Reduce the width before increasing the darkness.

Tool references: S9. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Separate fabric from the board

Select first: Cloth Contact – below Coat Texture

Tools / menu: Multiply; mask; soft brush



Cloth/board contact added. The underlying frame remains visible around the fabric.

DO THIS

- 1 Create **Cloth Contact** directly below Coat Texture but above the board/body layers. Set it to Multiply.
- 2 With a soft 8–15 px brush at 15–20% opacity, darken the small visible board-cover areas just beneath the coat edge.
- 3 Add only a little shadow where the hanging cloth is close to the stand. A support much farther behind the cloth should not receive the same sharp dark outline.
- 4 Use a mask to remove spill onto the studio. Toggle the layer to confirm that it separates surfaces rather than drawing a black border around the whole coat.

WHY The cloth and board occupy different depths. A local shadow helps describe that relationship without outlining every edge.

CHECK A small shadow is visible on the board; the fabric's entire silhouette is not surrounded by black.

FIX A uniform outline is not a cast shadow. Remove it and paint only on the surfaces that would actually receive the shadow.

Tool references: S9. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Anchor the hoof to the handle

Select first: Hoof Contact – above Iron Top, below Foreleg

Tools / menu: Multiply; small brush



Hoof contact added above the iron and below the foreleg.

DO THIS

- 1 Create **Hoof Contact** above Iron Top and below Foreleg. Set it to Multiply.
- 2 At 200%, use a soft **3-6 px** brush, Opacity 15-20%, to paint a short shadow on the handle immediately under the hoof.
- 3 Keep the hoof's edge visible over the handle. Use the Foreleg mask to correct any last fringe or awkward overlap.
- 4 Zoom out and ask a partner to point to the exact place where the hoof touches the iron. Adjust the contact if they cannot locate it quickly.

WHY This is the smallest contact point but the most important narrative detail: it makes the action readable.

CHECK The hoof, handle and contact shadow meet in one place, with no white gap.

FIX Do not add a dark ring all around the hoof. Put the shadow on the handle surface underneath it.

Tool references: S9. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Ground the zebra and the stand

Select first: Ground Shadow; Foot Contacts – above 01 Studio

Tools / menu: Elliptical Marquee; Fill; Gaussian Blur



Integration target with broad and tight ground shadows.

DO THIS

- 1 Create **Ground Shadow** above 01 Studio and below all objects. Use Elliptical Marquee to draw a broad, shallow oval under the scene. Choose **Edit > Fill > Color** and use a dark warm grey. Deselect with Ctrl/Cmd+D.
- 2 Choose **Filter > Blur > Gaussian Blur**, start around **18 px**, and lower the layer opacity to roughly **15-25%**. Offset this broad shadow slightly right.
- 3 Create **Foot Contacts** above it. Paint smaller, darker ovals immediately under each hind hoof and visible stand foot. Use about 3-5 px blur, or a small soft brush.
- 4 Keep all contact patches centred on actual points of contact. Do not add a patch where the coat merely hangs above the floor.

WHY The broad shadow suggests cast light; the smaller dark patches anchor weight. They solve different visual problems.

CHECK Every supporting foot meets the floor. The darkest small shadow touches each foot, while the wider shadow stays softer.

FIX A dark oval separated from a foot makes that foot float. Move the oval up to the contact point rather than making it larger.

Visual: teaching composite / annotation, not an application screenshot.

Match the photographed pieces

Select first: Clipped Curves / Hue-Saturation layers

Tools / menu: Adjustment layers; clipping masks



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Inspect the zebra, iron and coat at Fit on Screen. Decide which piece looks too bright, too warm or too high-contrast.
- 2 Select the affected base layer and choose **Layer > New Adjustment Layer > Curves**. Place it immediately above that object and clip it to that base. Move the curve's middle gently; do not apply one guessed setting to every object.
- 3 For a colour mismatch, add a clipped **Hue/Saturation** adjustment and start with a small Saturation reduction, about **-10**. Keep enough warm colour to match the studio.
- 4 Temporarily add a **Black & White** adjustment at the very top to compare brightness without colour. Hide that diagnostic layer before export. Recheck the separately posed Foreleg as well as the body.

WHY These photos were not shot together. Small object-specific adjustments help them appear to share the same lighting; the greyscale check isolates brightness differences.

CHECK No piece looks like a bright cut-out pasted into a darker scene. The separate foreleg still matches the torso.

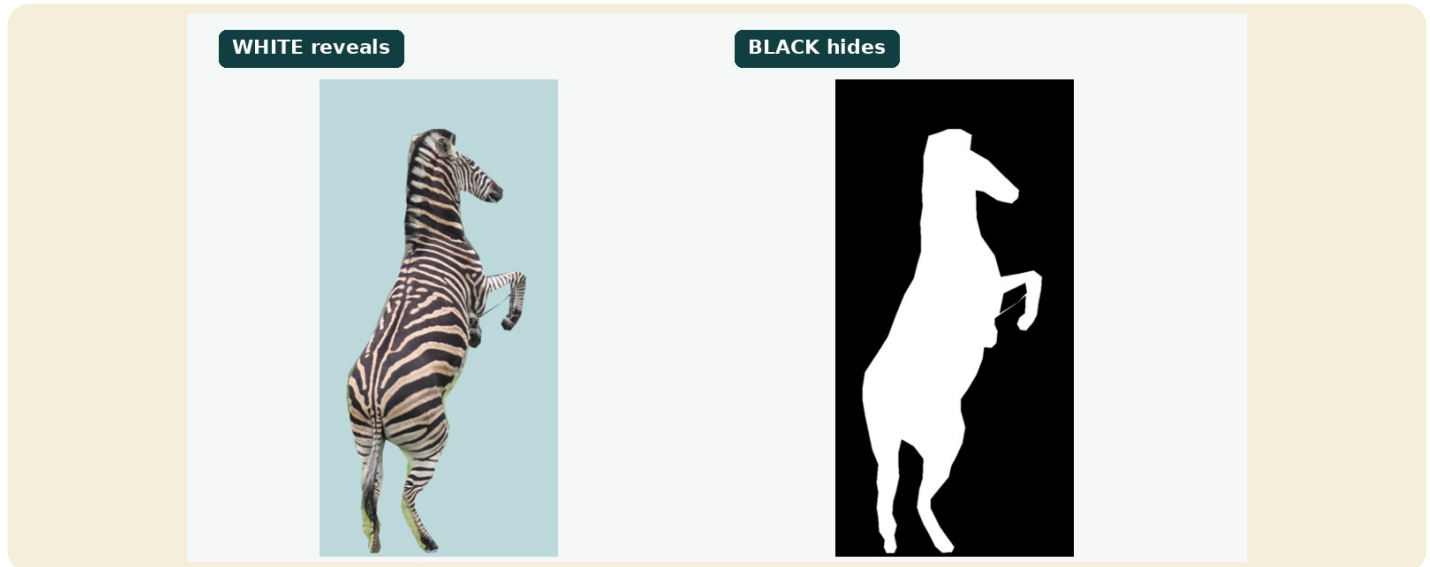
FIX An adjustment affecting the entire studio is not clipped. Move it beside the intended base and use **Layer > Create Clipping Mask**. Do not leave the diagnostic Black & White layer visible.

Tool references: S7. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Do a two-background edge inspection

Select first: Relevant object mask; optional Edge Cleanup layer

Tools / menu: Mask brush; Clone Stamp



Use the source mask diagram as a reminder; inspect your actual completed scene against both light and dark backdrops.

DO THIS

- 1 Inside 01 Studio, temporarily place one dark and one white Solid Color layer above the normal background. Toggle them one at a time to inspect each cut-out.
- 2 At 100%, check the back, belly, tail and hooves for green grass or grey fence. Correct the mask locally with a small brush; avoid shrinking the whole animal to fix one edge.
- 3 For coloured fringe inside an otherwise correct edge, add an **Edge Cleanup** pixel layer directly above the object and clip it. Use Clone Stamp with **Sample: Current & Below**, a small brush, and Alt/Option-click a nearby clean colour/texture before painting.
- 4 Hide the temporary inspection backgrounds. Check the whole picture at normal viewing size. Save a new version before adding type.

WHY A mask controls visibility; a fringe is sometimes a colour problem inside a visible edge. The two need different fixes.

CHECK No fence wedge, grass halo or leftover second zebra remains. The cut-outs look clean on both test backgrounds.

FIX Clone Stamp on an empty layer with Sample: Current Layer has nothing to copy. Use Current & Below and keep other foreground objects hidden while sampling.

Tool references: S2, S8. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Turn the composite into a visual advertisement

Select first: Type layers – above scene

Tools / menu: Horizontal Type; Character panel; Shape tool



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Select **Horizontal Type (T)**. Choose an available bold sans serif, such as Arial Bold or a similar school-installed font. Set colour to **#123F42**. Keep all type editable.
- 2 At roughly **x 970, y 240**, create three lines: **PRESS / YOUR / STRIPES.** Start around **95 pt** at this document's 72 ppi, with leading around 110 pt. Adjust the size so the block fits before x 1500.
- 3 Add a short orange rectangle below the headline. Add **A wild take on / laundry day.** at about 27 pt, positioned to the right of the cloth, around x 1070, y 665. Keep it clear of the board.
- 4 Add the fictional brand **FRESH COAT** near the lower right and a small line identifying it as a fictional campaign. Replace the copy with your own short, relevant idea only after the layout works.

WHY The image earns attention; the headline gives the joke a communication purpose. Clear hierarchy keeps the advertising task from becoming a random collage.

CHECK The headline is read first, the action is read second, and the small copy does not collide with the coat or board.

FIX Different fonts have different widths. Fit the text visually rather than forcing the same numeric size. Do not flatten or rasterize the type just to resize it.

Visual: teaching composite / annotation, not an application screenshot.

Audit the layer stack and save the master

Select first: Entire document
Tools / menu: Layers panel; Save As



Explanatory layer-order schematic, not an application screenshot. Add clipped corrections directly above their own object.

DO THIS

- 1 Turn key layers off and on: Foreleg, Iron Top, Coat Texture and Ground Shadow. Each should have a clear job. Confirm that no duplicate hoof or displaced lower iron appears.
- 2 Rename layers clearly. Keep the consecutive clipped coat stack together. Group finished work into **Studio**, **Grounding**, **Scene** and **Type** without changing the internal order.
- 3 Check at 100% for fringes, then Fit on Screen for the story. Hide all guides, selection outlines, test backgrounds and diagnostic adjustments.
- 4 Save **YourName_Zebra_Ironing_FINAL.psd**. Retain masks, Smart Objects and editable type. Close and reopen this saved file to confirm that it is your layered master.

WHY A convincing flat image is only part of the evidence. The layered master shows how the student constructed and can revise the result.

CHECK The final PSD opens correctly and retains editable construction. The supplied Untitled-2.psd has not been overwritten.

FIX A JPG is not a layered master. If the Layers panel contains only Background, return to the PSD saved before export.

Visual: teaching composite / annotation, not an application screenshot.

Export a clean viewing copy

Select first: Final PSD – normal colour view

Tools / menu: File > Export > Export As



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Choose **File > Export > Export As**. Select **JPG** for a complete poster with its background, or PNG when your teacher specifically asks for it.
- 2 Check the output dimensions: **1600 × 1200 px**. Choose a high JPG quality setting; interfaces may show different numeric scales.
- 3 Enable **Convert to sRGB** and Embed Color Profile where those options are available. Save as **YourName_Zebra_Ironing_FINAL.jpg**.
- 4 Open the exported file outside Photoshop. Look for clipping, missing layers, unwanted guides or accidental black-and-white output. Keep the PSD as well as the export.

WHY The export is easy to view or upload; the PSD preserves editing. A final outside-the-app check catches mistakes that are easy to miss in the working document.

CHECK Your JPG matches the intended final scene, opens normally, and has the correct filename and dimensions.

FIX Do not overwrite the PSD with a flat format. A transparent PNG is not needed for a complete poster that includes a designed background.

Tool references: S10. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Submit evidence and explain one decision

Select first: Final PSD, JPG and process evidence
Tools / menu: Screenshots; reflection



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Submit your final **PSD** and **JPG**, plus three process screenshots: refined animal mask, posed foreleg with layer structure, and warped coat with the mesh or relevant layers visible.
- 2 Write three brief responses: **Which contact point makes the illusion work best? Why is the coat below the iron but above the board? What did you change after a failed test?**
- 3 Identify every supplied or outside image used. Record any prepared support asset you used and any teacher-approved AI assistance; do not claim a prepared cut-out as your own selection work.
- 4 Perform one final partner check: can they read the action in five seconds, and can they find the strongest piece of masking, warping and shadow work?

WHY The evidence shows both the product and the thinking behind it. A useful reflection identifies a specific decision, not just that the task was fun or difficult.

CHECK Your submission contains the editable master, viewing image, three process captures and three short explanations.

FIX Missing an earlier screenshot? Demonstrate the live mask or warp controls to the teacher. Do not fabricate process evidence.

Visual: teaching composite / annotation, not an application screenshot.

Optional: the coat comes off

Your core project is complete. Save a separate PSD before trying either extension so the successful version remains intact.



Core: the zebra retains its stripes.



X1-X2: a smooth cream costume under the striped panel.

X1-X2 / a plain costume

Replace the torso pattern with an opaque, masked cream fill, then rebuild its rounded volume. This is an illustrated costume treatment. It is not photorealistic fur restoration or a claim about real anatomy.

X3-X4 / a different expression

Extract an alternate head, then solve neck alignment, masking and tone. A different camera angle limits the result; the original head is an entirely valid final choice.

Keep the distinction clear

The coat itself is fabricated from a stripe patch in both versions. Desaturating a torso will not remove black-and-white stripes. A larger change means rebuilding texture or using the intentionally smooth costume approach.

Choose one extension first. Do not sacrifice a convincing core scene to add a difficult head swap or an unfinished stripe-removal effect.

Build a plain cream costume panel

Select first: Plain Coat Base – clipped fill above Zebra Body

Tools / menu: Lasso; Solid Color; layer mask



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Save an extension copy of your PSD. Keep the successful striped-animal version. This option is a **stylised costume illusion**, not a claim about real zebra anatomy.
- 2 Above Zebra Body, create a Solid Color fill named **Plain Coat Base**, using a sampled warm cream, approximately **#ECDEC4**. Clip it to Zebra Body.
- 3 Click its white mask and press **Ctrl/Cmd+I** to make the mask black. With a soft white brush, reveal the fill across the torso only. Leave the head, mane, tail, hoof tips and most limbs striped.
- 4 Keep the fill at Normal, 100% where the black stripes must disappear. Do not use Color blend mode or desaturation to remove black-and-white stripes. Preserve a little natural edge fur with the mask.

WHY A plain costume beneath the striped fabric makes the “coat taken off” joke explicit. The full-opacity replacement is intentional; lowering saturation cannot erase a luminance pattern.

CHECK The torso becomes a cream costume shape, while the separate striped fabric and recognisable zebra features remain.

FIX A Curves lift only fades stripes. That can be a valid alternate style, but it is not complete stripe removal. Name and judge the result honestly.

Tool references: S7. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Restore volume to the plain costume

Select first: Costume Shade / Light – restricted to the panel

Tools / menu: Multiply; Screen; optional Clone Stamp



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Above Plain Coat Base, add a blank **Costume Shade** layer. Restrict it to the same torso area with a copy of the fill's mask: Alt/Option-drag that mask onto the new layer. Set the layer to Multiply.
- 2 With a large soft brush at 5–10% opacity, shade the body's right edge, lower belly and area beneath the shoulder. Build broad form, not thin outlines.
- 3 Add **Costume Light** with the same mask and a very low-opacity Screen brush along the upper-left-facing body. The reference deliberately uses a smooth, illustrated costume finish.
- 4 For a textured challenge, add a masked pixel layer and use Clone Stamp to sample clean cream fur from the original photo into small areas. Use several source points and follow fur direction. Do not stretch one tiny sample over the entire torso.

WHY Covering the stripes also covers the shading that described the animal. Rebuilding light and shadow prevents the plain section from looking like flat white paint.

CHECK The body still looks rounded. Its lighting agrees with the head, board and fabric, even though the costume treatment is stylised.

FIX A smooth cream panel is acceptable for the illustrated extension, but should not be described as photorealistic fur restoration. Retaining texture takes additional careful retouching.

Tool references: S8, S9. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Extract an alternate head

Select first: Head Source – separate source document

Tools / menu: Object Selection; Select and Mask



Source-matched teaching composite or annotation; not a Photoshop screenshot.

DO THIS

- 1 Open **Zebra_in_South_Africa.jpg**. This close-up supplies an alternate expression; it is not the body-pose source.
- 2 Select the head, both ears, central mane and a generous short section of neck. Exclude the other zebra crossing the foreground and the green background.
- 3 Refine the ear and mane edges in Select and Mask. Output a layer mask, then convert the masked result into a Smart Object.
- 4 Duplicate the head layer into the main PSD and place it above Zebra Body. Name it **Alternate Head**. Keep the original head until the new head's scale and neck overlap have been checked.

WHY An expression change can increase personality, but it adds an alignment and lighting problem. It is optional, not necessary to complete the ironing illusion.

CHECK The new head is a separate, recoverable cut-out with enough neck to blend. No second animal or green rectangle comes with it.

FIX A full front-facing head cannot be made into a true side view with a small warp. Accept a deliberate head turn or keep the original head.

Tool references: S1, S2, S3. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Select first: Alternate Head mask; Zebra Body mask; clipped adjustments
Tools / menu: Free Transform; mask; Curves



- 1 Scale the head proportionally. Align the base of its neck with the body neck and keep the head size comparable to the original. Rotate only enough to make the connection plausible.
- 2 Once placed, use the **Zebra Body outer mask** to hide the old head where it would show behind the replacement. Do not erase it.
- 3 On the Alternate Head mask, blend only the overlapping neck. Preserve the outer jaw and ear edges. Match brightness and warmth with clipped Curves and Hue/Saturation adjustments.
- 4 Check at 100% and Fit on Screen. A sharp stripe mismatch across the neck may need a small texture patch or a different overlap position. Keep the simpler original head when the replacement weakens the illusion.

WHY A head swap is not just pasting a face. Scale, pose, neck continuity, edge quality and tone all have to agree.

CHECK There is one head, a believable neck attachment, and consistent lighting. The source PSD image here is an earlier draft, not a finished quality target.

FIX Do not cover a broken neck join with a huge soft brush. Reposition first, then use restrained masking and local texture repair.

Tool references: S7, S8. Settings and coordinates are authored starting points.

Find the problem, not a random filter

Check the selected layer or mask first. Undo a wrong-target edit before trying another tool.

Both zebras selected

Step 05 · selection

Use Object Selection locally, then Subtract the right-hand animal. Check the gap between legs with Lasso rather than trusting a single automatic click.

White or green edge halo

Steps 06, 26 · mask / edge pixels

Check on light and dark backdrops. Refine the mask first. Where colour remains inside the silhouette, use a clipped correction or short Clone Stamp repair; do not blur the entire subject.

Puppet Warp shows a large rectangle

Steps 07, 12–13 · Foreleg Smart Object

Cancel. Enclose the isolated, masked limb in a fresh Smart Object. Select its image thumbnail, not the mask, before opening Puppet Warp.

Two hooves or a shoulder gap

Steps 12–14 · Zebra Body / Foreleg masks

Hide the old limb on the body mask. Restore a little shoulder overlap. Adjust pose before trying to paint over a badly placed joint.

The iron has doubled edges

Step 11 · Iron Top

The copy must stay aligned with Board Base. Undo a move or realign it. Do not shift the top iron while the original remains visible underneath.

Make the pieces belong together

Check the selected layer or mask first. Undo a wrong-target edit before trying another tool.

The coat looks like a flat rectangle

Steps 17–20 · mesh / clipped paint

Compress the upper row into a shallow tabletop plane. Let the hem sag and add broad, restrained light and dark folds. A dropped shadow alone will not create cloth volume.

Fabric covers the iron or vanishes behind the board

Steps 16, 28 · layer order

Coat Texture belongs above Board Base and Zebra Body, but below Iron Top and Foreleg. Keep fold paint clipped to the coat. See the layer sandwich diagram.

Objects float above the floor

Steps 21–24 · contact shadows

Check position first. Then add small dark contact shadows at touching surfaces and a softer, broader ground shadow. A large black oval does not prove contact.

A pale torso still has black stripes

X1 · Plain Coat Base

Desaturation cannot erase a black-and-white pattern. For the illustrated extension, use an opaque cream fill restricted by a torso mask, then restore volume with local shading.

Only a flat final image remains

Steps 28–30 · saved files

Return to the layered PSD. Export a separate JPG. Keep the source files and earlier versioned PSD until the final master has been reopened and checked.

Show the product and the thinking

Submission: layered PSD + final JPG + three genuine process captures (refined mask, foreleg pose and coat warp) + three short explanations. Record the sources and any prepared support used.

Suggested assessment criteria

Masking & editability	Clean outer edges; sensible refinements; recoverable masks; meaningful layer names; Smart Objects where instructed.
Pose & fabric construction	One connected working foreleg; hoof meets the handle; fabric crosses the board edge with continuous stripes and a shaped hem.
Integration & communication	Appropriate occlusion, contact and ground shadows; coherent tone; a readable visual joke and clear type hierarchy.
Evidence & explanation	Layered PSD and JPG; three authentic process captures; specific revision explanation; source/support acknowledgement.

A short reflection

1. Point to the contact that most convincingly connects the photographs. Explain the layer order and shadow at that point.
2. Explain why the fabric sits above the board but below the iron. What would a wrong order look like?
3. Describe one failed attempt, the visual evidence that it was not working, and the specific change you made.

Optional classroom scoring

4	Secure and intentional; can explain and revise choices independently.
3	Meets the core expectation with minor errors.
2	Partly demonstrated; a key construction or explanation needs support.
1	Minimal evidence; substantial guided rebuilding is needed.
0	No assessable evidence yet; provide another opportunity to demonstrate.

Teacher-made rubric: four criteria × 0–4 = 16 possible points. This is not an official IB or jurisdictional grade conversion. Support use affects the evidence available, not an automatic grade. A live demonstration can replace a missed process capture; do not fabricate evidence.

Teacher preflight before release

- Check the installed Photoshop.** Use Photoshop on desktop for this walkthrough. In one test file, verify Place Embedded, Select and Mask, Puppet Warp on the nested limb, and a 3x3 Transform Warp. Do not assume web or tablet controls match.
- Walk through the difficult joins.** Test the left-animal overlap, shoulder separation, iron duplicate and first cloth-fold row. The guide’s coordinates are targets; selections and fonts can vary. Do a teacher sample before assigning independently.
- Choose a route before class.** Decide who starts with raw images and who may use prepared cut-outs. Prepared supports preserve access to later skills, but they are not evidence of a student-created selection.
- Protect the thinking.** Ask students to show a live mask, pin or mesh and explain why it is there. No generative fill is required for the core task. Record any permitted AI assistance rather than treating a finished image as sufficient process evidence.
- Respect imagery and provenance.** The photos and rough PSD were supplied by the teacher/user. Their original licences and creators were not established here. Verify permission and attribution before public redistribution or posting the source files.
- Know what was verified.** The HTML/PDF layout and assets can be checked here. The illustrations are programmatic photo composites, not genuine Photoshop screenshots. Adobe documentation was researched; an end-to-end local Photoshop run was not performed.

Suggested 70-minute-class sequence

Class 1	Steps 01–10: plan, isolate the animal, arrange and repair the prop.
Class 2	Steps 11–18: separate the iron/foreleg, pose the hoof, extract and warp the cloth.
Class 3	Steps 19–26: fold shading, contact shadows, ground, tone and edge inspection.
Class 4	Steps 27–30: advertisement, file audit, evidence and reflection.
Class 5 / flexibility	Revisions, conferencing or an extension. Raw-asset beginners may need this time; prepared cut-outs can shorten the route.

A useful conference: “Show the layer that makes the hoof touch the handle. Hide it. What changes? Now show the mesh that makes the fabric bend.”

Adobe tool references

Adobe documentation was checked on 17 September 2026. This is an original classroom reconstruction using the supplied assets and the rough layered PSD as a construction reference, not a verified transcription of an original zebra tutorial. Project coordinates, brush values and timing estimates are authored starting points.

S1 • Adobe: Object Selection

Confirms rectangle/lasso object selection, adding and subtracting regions, and sampling options.

[Open the Adobe documentation](#)

S2 • Adobe: Select and Mask

Confirms preview modes and refinement choices. The small edge settings in this lesson are starting points chosen for these photos.

[Open the Adobe documentation](#)

S3 • Adobe: Embedded Smart Objects

Confirms Place Embedded, converting selected layers, and opening the embedded contents for editing.

[Open the Adobe documentation](#)

S4 • Adobe: Puppet Warp

Confirms Edit > Puppet Warp, anchor pins, pin movement and non-destructive use on Smart Objects.

[Open the Adobe documentation](#)

S5 • Adobe: Transform Warp

Confirms Edit > Transform > Warp, 3x3 meshes and control-point manipulation.

[Open the Adobe documentation](#)

Project values are examples, not Adobe presets. Use the illustrated relationships, then adjust settings to suit the actual image and installed Photoshop version.

Sources, rights and verification

The linked Adobe pages document the tools. They do not endorse this composition or establish ownership of the supplied photographs.

S6 • Adobe: Split Warp controls

Additional control for more advanced mesh work; not required for the basic 3x3 approach.

[Open the Adobe documentation](#)

S7 • Adobe: Clipping masks

Confirms that the base layer determines where clipped layers show and gives the Layer > Create Clipping Mask command.

[Open the Adobe documentation](#)

S8 • Adobe: Clone Stamp

Confirms Current & Below sampling, Aligned sampling, opacity and flow controls.

[Open the Adobe documentation](#)

S9 • Adobe: Blending modes

Reference for Multiply, Screen and other blend modes used in compositing.

[Open the Adobe documentation](#)

S10 • Adobe: Export As

Confirms File > Export > Export As and format-specific export controls.

[Open the Adobe documentation](#)

Source imagery and prepared studies

Source photos and the rough PSD were supplied in this conversation. No licence or photographer attribution is asserted for them here. Keep attribution records and confirm rights before publicly redistributing the source pack. Adobe links document tools, not ownership of these images.

The aligned PNG layers in support/aligned_layers are raster construction studies with baked transforms and shading. They are not substitutes for the student-built Smart Objects, masks, clipped adjustments or editable type.

The reference and checkpoints are programmatically assembled from the supplied photographs; they are teaching composites, not Photoshop screenshots. The Photoshop workflow is researched but has not been run end-to-end in a local Photoshop installation. Tool labels and automatic selections should be preflighted on the school version.